American Red Cross
Southeastern Pennsylvania

Supporting Military-Connected Clients

Quick Reference Tool for SRT and Caseworkers

As Red Cross caseworker, you play an important role in the support of our military-connected families. This Quick Reference Tool is specifically for our SEPA Region. Please also reference the **SEPA Supporting Military-Connected Clients Job Tool** for additional important information and resources.

Military Benefits

- Military benefits are **unique to each individual**. Clients are best served by encouraging them to contact federal, state or local service centers that specialize in access and review of their benefits (*see Pennsylvania Information below*). Benefits are available to veterans who were Honorably Discharged.
- The U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) benefits and claims information and assistance can also be obtained through the **national toll free** # (800) 827-1000, TDD (800) 829-4833.

Pennsylvania Information

Pennsylvania Department of Military and Veterans Affairs (DMVA)

- Anyone needing help in locating their military documentation can call DMVA at 800-547-2838 or email RA-REQ@pa.gov.

County Directors of Veterans Affairs

- A County Veterans Affairs Director is a public official who serves as the local point of contact for veterans and their families within a county.
  - Bucks: https://www.buckscounty.gov/directory.aspx?did=87
  - Chester: https://www.chesco.org/155/Veterans-Affairs
  - Delaware: https://www.delcopa.gov/department-military-and-veterans-affairs
  - Montgomery: https://www.montgomerycountypa.gov/266/Veteran-Services
  - Philadelphia: https://phlcouncil.com/veterans/contact-us/

Veterans Service Officers (VSOs)

VSOs assist veterans in navigating the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) benefits system, helping with claims, appeals, and accessing various services.

- **The Veterans Multi-Service Center**: https://www.vmcenter.org/
  - Services include housing program support.

- American Legion, Veterans of Foreign Wars, AMVETS, Disabled American Veterans: If client is a member of these organizations, have them contact their local chapter for support. Note: these organizations may have financial aid for members who need disaster support.

Veterans Temporary Assistance (VTA) Program

- The DMVA administers the VTA program which provides temporary financial assistance up to $1,600 for necessities including food, shelter, fuel and clothing within a 12-month period to eligible veterans and their beneficiaries who reside in Pennsylvania. Veterans interested in applying for a VTA grant should contact the **County Director of Veterans Affairs** (see above) within the county where they reside.

Additional Resources

- Veterans who **receive healthcare through VA Medical Centers** are provided with team-based care referred to as a **PACT (Patient Aligned Care Team)**. The PACT includes a **Social Worker** that can also assist with recovery.
- **Legal Aid of Southeastern PA** has a **Veterans Unit**. Contact Legal Aid Veterans Advocacy Helpline: 610-283-0884 or Veterans — Legal Aid of Southeastern Pennsylvania

Pre-Disaster and Post-Disaster Veterans

In the Red Cross, we use two ways to define Homeless: **Pre-Disaster Homeless** and **Post-Disaster Homeless**.

- **Post-Disaster Homeless:** For veterans who have lost housing due to a disaster, these clients should contact the *National Call Center for Homeless Veterans* at (877) 4AID-VET (877-424-3838) for assistance. Clients will be routed to local resources for assistance.
- **Pre-Disaster Homeless Veterans:** The Red Cross will collaborate with the local veteran organizations for support. Discuss these clients with your supervisor.

American Red Cross Resources

- Custom **Hero Care** resource directory: https://herocare.findhelp.com/
- **Emergency Communication Services** for families needing to contact **active-duty service members**: Hero Care Center at 877-272-7337.
- **Peer Support Groups**
  - *Military & Veteran Caregiver Network* (MVCN) Caregivers of all eras, all relations, across all locations Military and Veteran Caregiver Network | American Red Cross
  - *Military 2 Veteran Network* (M2VN) – **Launching Fall 2026**. For active-duty service members and veterans. Military 2 Veteran Network - OneSource